



PHP forms 15m

HTML forms are used to gather information from the user which is then submitted to the server for processing. This process is done by using an HTTP method called POST request. PHP is then used to extract the data from these POST requests and use that data to perform server-side operations.



We've already discussed HTML forms and how to create a simple form using only HTML. If you need a refresher, we recommend returning to the page:

[HTML form elements](#) ➔

The POST method is used to transfer information via the HTTP headers. If you are using a secure HTTP, then the data sent by the POST method is secure. There is no limit to the amount of information you can send via the POST method.

The HTTP protocol is used extensively in web application development, therefore it is recommended to familiarise yourself further with it. MDN Web Docs has a good overview of HTTP.

There is also the GET method, which can be used to send data from the form to the server. However, the information sent from a form with the GET method is limited in the number of characters that can be sent, and the information is visible to everyone in the URL, so it is not secure. The GET method should never be used for sensitive information. Because of this, we will focus on the POST method.

The POST method is preferred by web developers for sending form data.

[Skip to main content](#)

The following CodePen example shows an HTML page containing a simple form that gathers details from a customer in order to start a registration process. This form uses a POST request.

The form contains the user's first name, last name, email address and chosen password. It includes some HTML5 validation checks.



The validation in the following CodePen will not run in iQualify due to iframe restrictions. To test the validation, select "Open in new tab" on "Edit on CodePen".



[Skip to main content](#)

HTML

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

```
<!DOCTYPE HTML>
<html><head><title>Register new
customer</title> </head>
  <body>
    <h1>New Customer
Registration</h1>
    <form method="POST"
action="registercustomer.php">
      <p>
        <label for="firstname">Name:
</label>
        <input type="text"
id="firstname" name="firstname"
minlength="5" maxlength="50"
required>
      </p>
      <p>
        <label for="lastname">Last
Name: </label>
        <input type="text"
id="lastname" name="lastname"
minlength="5" maxlength="50"
required>
      </p>
      <p>
        <label for="email">Email:
</label>
        <input type="email" id="email"
name="email" minlength="5"
maxlength="50" required>
      </p>
    </form>
  </body>
</html>
```

Resources 1x 0.5x 0.25x Rerun

Example 9.1 PHP forms



To process this form, you need to add some PHP code that can receive the form data and then perform server-side operations with the data.



[Skip to main content](#)

Thoughts on this page?

